



Insects arrive to gather pollen and nectar, but the plant doesn't need them to make seeds.

Blossoming

Flower heads appear at the ends of long stems. Each head is actually a cluster of many small petal-shaped flowers called ray florets. Every ray floret can form a seed.



Dandelion

Unlike many flowering plants, dandelions usually make seeds without being pollinated. This is known as asexual reproduction. However, insects still visit dandelions to collect pollen and nectar. A relationship like this, in which one partner (the insect) is helped and the other (the dandelion) is unaffected, is called commensalism.



Spring growth

In spring, leaves sprout from the plant's main root, called a taproot, which has survived the winter underground. The root goes deep into the soil to get water and nutrients to feed the plant.



House mouse Like dandelions and insects, humans and mice have a commensal relationship—one partner benefits and the other doesn't. Mice find shelter and food in our homes. Apart from their droppings and gnawings, they cause us little bother, although they can carry disease.

